Lessons Learned Template

Purple Team Exercise Lessons Learned

Session Information

Field	Value
Exercise Name	
Exercise Date(s)	
Facilitation Date	
Facilitator	
Participants	
Duration	

Pre-Session Preparation

Materials Needed

- ❑ Exercise tracking data and metrics
- ❑ After-action report (draft or final)
- ❑ Detection logs and evidence
- ❑ Participant list and roles
- ❑ Whiteboard or collaborative document for capture
- ❑ Previous lessons learned (if available)

Agenda

Time	Activity	Duration
	Welcome and ground rules	5 min
	Exercise recap	10 min
	What went well	15 min
	What could be improved	15 min
	Root cause analysis	15 min
	Action item generation	15 min
	Prioritization and assignment	10 min
	Next steps and close	5 min

Ground Rules

Read these at the start of each session:

1. **Blameless culture** - Focus on processes, not people
2. **Speak freely** - All perspectives are valuable
3. **One conversation** - No side discussions
4. **Capture everything** - Ideas first, prioritize later
5. **Respect time** - Keep on schedule
6. **Action-oriented** - Every issue needs an owner

Exercise Recap

Quick Statistics

Metric	Value
TTPs Executed	
TTPs Detected	
Detection Rate	%
Average TTD	min
Action Items from Exercise	

Objectives Review

Objective	Status	Notes
	Achieved / Partial / Not Achieved	
	Achieved / Partial / Not Achieved	
	Achieved / Partial / Not Achieved	

What Went Well

Capture positive aspects of the exercise. What should we continue doing?

Planning & Preparation

#	What Worked	Impact	Continue?
1			Yes / No
2			Yes / No
3			Yes / No

Execution

#	What Worked	Impact	Continue?
1			Yes / No
2			Yes / No
3			Yes / No

Collaboration

#	What Worked	Impact	Continue?
1			Yes / No
2			Yes / No
3			Yes / No

Detection & Response

#	What Worked	Impact	Continue?
1			Yes / No
2			Yes / No
3			Yes / No

What Could Be Improved

Capture areas for improvement without blame. Focus on processes and systems.

Planning & Preparation Issues

#	Issue	Impact	Root Cause	Improvement Idea
1				
2				
3				

Execution Issues

#	Issue	Impact	Root Cause	Improvement Idea
1				
2				
3				

Communication Issues

#	Issue	Impact	Root Cause	Improvement Idea
1				
2				
3				

Technical Issues

#	Issue	Impact	Root Cause	Improvement Idea
1				
2				
3				

Root Cause Analysis

For significant issues, perform deeper analysis using the "5 Whys" technique.

Issue 1: [Title]

Problem Statement: [Clear description of the issue]

Level	Why?
Why 1	
Why 2	
Why 3	
Why 4	
Why 5	

Root Cause: [Final determination]

Recommended Fix: [Systemic solution]

Issue 2: [Title]

Problem Statement: [Clear description of the issue]

Level	Why?
Why 1	
Why 2	
Why 3	
Why 4	
Why 5	

Root Cause: [Final determination]

Recommended Fix: [Systemic solution]

Surprises and Discoveries

What unexpected things did we learn?

#	Discovery	Implication	Action Needed?
1			Yes / No
2			Yes / No
3			Yes / No
4			Yes / No

Action Items

Immediate (This Week)

#	Action	Owner	Due Date	Status
1				Open
2				Open
3				Open

Short-Term (30 Days)

#	Action	Owner	Due Date	Status
1				Open
2				Open
3				Open

Long-Term (90+ Days)

#	Action	Owner	Due Date	Status
1				Open
2				Open
3				Open

Process Improvements

Exercise Planning

Current State	Desired State	Change Required

Exercise Execution

Current State	Desired State	Change Required

Detection Capabilities

Current State	Desired State	Change Required

Documentation & Reporting

Current State	Desired State	Change Required

Recommendations for Next Exercise

Do More Of

1.
2.
3.

Do Less Of

1.
2.
3.

Start Doing

1.
2.
3.

Stop Doing

1.
2.
3.

Feedback by Role

Red Team Feedback

What helped you succeed:

What hindered you:

Suggestions for improvement:

Blue Team Feedback

What helped you succeed:

What hindered you:

Suggestions for improvement:

CTI Team Feedback

What helped you succeed:

What hindered you:

Suggestions for improvement:

Exercise Coordinator Feedback

What worked well:

What was challenging:

Suggestions for improvement:

Metrics Comparison

Compare against previous exercises if available

Metric	Previous	Current	Trend	Target
Detection Rate	%	%	↑/↓/→	%
Avg TTD	min	min	↑/↓/→	min
Exercise Duration	hrs	hrs	↑/↓/→	hrs
Action Items Generated			↑/↓/→	
Action Items Completed			↑/↓/→	

Session Notes

Free-form notes from the lessons learned session

Key Discussion Points

Parking Lot Items

Items raised but deferred for later discussion

#	Item	Owner	Follow-up Date
1			
2			
3			

Sign-Off

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Facilitator			
Red Team Lead			
Blue Team Lead			
Exercise Coordinator			

Follow-Up Schedule

Milestone	Date	Owner
Action items assigned		
30-day check-in		
60-day check-in		
Pre-next-exercise review		

Template version: PTEFv4 Purple Team Exercise Framework - github.com/scythe-io/purple-team-exercise-framework